EXTRACTS FROM *THE VOICE OF THE SILENCE*:

For mind is like a mirror; it gathers dust while it reflects. It needs the gentle breezes of Soul Wisdom to brush away the dust of our illusions. Seek, O Beginner, to blend thy Mind and Soul.

. . . . . .

The wheel of the good Law moves swiftly on. It grinds by night and day. The worthless husks it drives from out the golden grain, the refuse from the flour. The hand of Karma guides the wheel; the revolutions mark the beatings of the Karmic heart.

. . . . . .

Sow kindly acts and thou shalt reap their fruition. Inaction in a deed of mercy becomes an action in a deadly sin.

Thus saith the Sage.

Shalt thou abstain from action? Not so shall gain thy soul her freedom. To reach Nirvâna one must reach Self-Knowledge, and Self-Knowledge is of loving deeds the child.

. . . . . .

To live to benefit mankind is the first step. To practice the six glorious virtues is the second.

. . . . . .

Thou canst create this "day" thy chances for thy "morrow." In the "Great Journey," causes sown each hour bear each its harvest of effects, for rigid Justice rules the World. With mighty sweep of never erring action, it brings to mortals lives of weal or woe, the Karmic progeny of all our former thoughts and deeds.

. . . . . .

Be humble, if thou would'st attain to Wisdom.

Be humbler still, when Wisdom thou hast mastered.

Be like the Ocean which receives all streams and rivers. The Ocean's mighty calm remains unmoved; it feels them not.

. . . . . .

Prepare thyself, for thou wilt have to travel on alone. The Teacher can but point the

way. The Path is one for all, the means to reach the goal must vary with the Pilgrims.

. . . . . .

Of teachers there are many; the MASTER-SOUL is one, Alaya, the Universal Soul. Live in that MASTER as ITS ray in thee. Live in thy fellows as they live in IT.

. . . . . .

Behold, the mellow light that floods the Eastern sky. In signs of praise both heaven and earth unite. And from the four-fold manifested Powers a chant of love ariseth, both from the flaming Fire and flowing Water, and from sweet-smelling Earth and rushing Wind.

Hark! . . . from the deep unfathomable vortex of that golden light in which the Victor bathes, ALL NATURE'S wordless voice in thousand tones ariseth to proclaim:

Joy unto ye, O men of Myalba [Earth].

A PILGRIM HATH RETURNED BACK "FROM THE OTHER SHORE."

A NEW ARHAN [Savior of humanity] IS BORN. . . .

[316] *Peace to all beings.*

Spatial Metaphor Exercise

In Fragment I of *The Voice of the Silence*, the twelve metaphors listed below are used to suggest a "map" of the territory pointed at in the text. For next week, try to come up with a visual model which includes these twelve and any other spatial metaphors one finds in this fragment.

Region of Asat

Realm of Sat

Hall of Sorrow

Valley of True Light

Hall of Ignorance

Hall of Learning

Hall of Wisdom

Valley of Bliss

Fount of Omniscience

Waters of Renunciation

Fields of Charity Immortal

The Land of Silence & Non-Being

Fragments of Fragment I of *The Voice of the Silence*

Cast	Action		Scene		
Who ?	What?	How?	Where?	When?	Why?
Ignorant Pupil Disciple Chela Lanoo			Regioo of *Asat* Realm of *Sat* Earth Hall of Sorrow Dismal Entrance Protective Shrine		
Soul Ego			Waves of Space Webs of Illusioo Traps to Ensnare Vale of Bliss Valley of True Light Wings of Great Bird Rest Eternal Akshara Hall of *Avidya* Hall of Learning Hall of Wisdom Fields of Charity Waters of Renunciation		
Mara Great Ensnarer Mocking Demon of Illusion					
Nada Silent Speaker					

First Fragment Hermeneutic Possibilities

The Mind <Who> slays <How> the Real <What> in the region of *Asat* <Where>.

The Disciple <Who> may slay <How> the Mind <What> by learning *Dharana* in order to hear the voice of *Nada* <Why> in the realm of *Sat*.

When the Disciple's form <Who/What> appears unreal as in dreams <Where/When>, s(he) may discern the ONE.

If the Disciple <Who> wants to see through the soul <What>, s(he) must attain Harmony within through *Dharana and Dhyana <How>*.

Region of Asat - The False
"Sir Mador was a very strong and powerful knight" - (evil)

Realm of Sat - The True
"At that Sir Lancelot lifted his sword and smote Sir Mador" - (good)

Hall of Sorrow - Earthly traps to ensnare the EGO by illusion

"For now that the Grail had been lifted from the earth, there was naught to hold together the Court of King Arthur as it had been held altogether before. Each knight began to think only of his own glory and not the glory of the Good of the world."

Hall of Wisdom - beyond which stretches the shoreless waters of AKSHARA

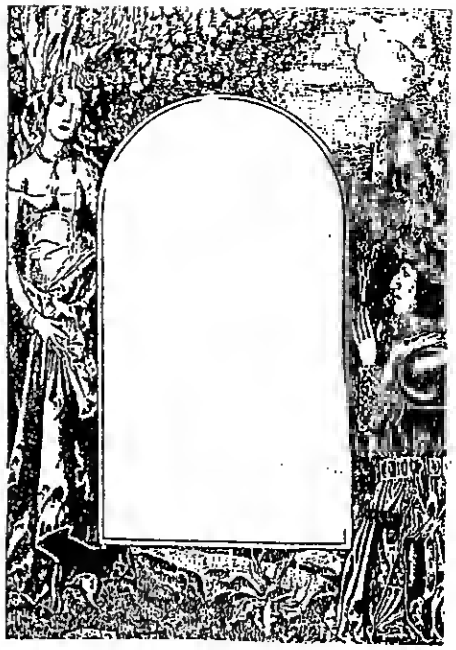
"Quote Sir Bors, "Sir, this life does not seem thee to lead, wherefore place upon thee armor and sally forth with us into the world again. And Sir Lanceot said, Nay, I will not leave this place for here I dwell in peace and amity with the world."

Fount of Omniscience - Full spiritual consciousness

"They went to the bed of Sir Lancelot who was lying peacefully on his couch. And Sir Bors went to Lancelot to arouse him and found him dead. And the hands of Sir Lancelot were folded upon his breast, and there was a smile of great peace and good content upon his lips.'

Valley of True Light - The light that no wind can extinguish

"Sir Lancelot beheld the windows of the chapel that they were illuminated from within with a pale blue lustre, then the light grew stronger. Then the walls of the chapel opened like a door and a light shone forth with a remarkable lustre. And then a bright shining spear appeared held by two fair hands, and after the spear, there came forth a chalice that sent forth a light of so dazzling radiance that it was though one looked at the bright shining sun in all its glory.



Hall of Ignorance - Hall in which thou saw'st the light in which thou livest and shall die.

"Sir Galahad kneeled before the Lady of the Lake and he set his palms together. But she smiled and said to him, Arise, Galahad, and kneel not to me, who am not the spirit, but of the earth."

Waters of Renunciation - Renouncing of All Sin

"And Sir Bedivere took King Arthur's sword ExCalibur and cast it out over the water and beheld that the sword whirled, flashing in the moonlight like to pure circles of light above the water and it descended to the water, and as the sword descended there emerged from the water an arm. And around the arm was a sleeve of white amite, and it catched the sword by the hilt and brandished it thrice and then drew it down beneath the water. And the water closed over it and the sword and arm were gone."

Fields of Charity Immortal - Compassion for those in need

Then King Arthur opened his eyes and said, For wit you know that I shall not die in this place, but that I shall go in this boat with my sister Queen Morgana to Avalon. There in the Vale of Avalon I shall live, and by and by after many years I shall gain return to Britain and no man shall know my return. But with this return shall come peace, end of suffering and tranquility. And war shall be nor more, but the arts of peace shall flourish."

EDITIONS

The Voice of the Silence, Being Chosen Fragments from the "Book of the Golden Precepts." For the Daily Use of Lanoos (Disciples). 1889. First ed. London: Theosophical Publishing Company; New York: W. Q. Judge. (In fact the volumes published in London and New York are different editions, with slight variations of text.)

The Voice of the Silence. 1892. Second ed. with slight textual changes by Annie Besant.

The Voice of the Silence and Other Chosen Fragments from the Book of the Golden Precepts. 1909. Seventh reprint. London: Theosophical Publishing Society. Pp. 100. Incorporates HPB's glossary notes into the text as footnotes.

The Voice of the Silence and Other Chosen Fragments from the Book of the Golden Precepts. 1925. 12th reprint. Wheaton, IL: Theosophical Press, 15th reprint, 1934. Pp. 104. Incorporates HPB's glossary notes into the text as footnotes; with slight abridgment of the text following the second ed. of 1892.

The Voice of the Silence, Being Chosen Fragments from the "Book of the Golden Precepts." For the Daily Use of Lanoos (Disciples). 1927. Reprinted from the original ed. with notes and comments by Alice Leighton Cleather and Basil Crump. Peking: Chinese Buddhist Research Society. Pp. [vi], xiv, 129. Reprinted by the H.P.B. Lending Library, Vernon, B.C., 1978.

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message of the 9th Panchen Lama. Santa Barbara: Concord Gove Press. Pp. xvi, 232. With appendices (pp. 111-232); incorporates HPB's glossary notes into the text on the left-hand pages.

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Tape #3
VOICE OF THE SILENCE - Algeo
1/12/83

THE TWO PATHS

First Path	Second Path (182-3)
Doctrine/Dharma of the Eye	Doctrine/Dharma of the Heart (102,111,127-8)
Head learning	Heart wisdom (106,111)
Exoteric	Esoteric (102n)
For the crowd	For the elect (119)
Open path	Secret path (143,146,180,196)
	The greater Yana (196)
Samtan of eye doctrine, fourfold Dhyana	Six Paramitas, noble gates of virtue (198)
Rugged path of fourfold Dhyana	Paramita heights, still steeper path (199,200)
On Sowan's Path, secure	Arhata Path (296,299)
Dhyana Path, haven of the Yogi	Arya path, Path of the Buddhas of perfection (298,302,306)
"Behold, I know"	"Thus have I heard" (119)
Pride	Humbleness (119)
To renounce all pity	To love all beings (123-4)
Selves sacrificed to self	Sacrifice the Self to weaker selves (142,146)
Nirvanic path, Nirvana-dharma (304-5)	
Way to selfish bliss	To live to benefit mankind (143-4)
To reach Nirvana's bliss	To renounce Nirvana's bliss (145)
Reach Nirvana	Cast the prize away (177)
Liberation	Renunciation (178,182-3)
Bliss immediate	Bliss deferred (179)
Leadeth to the goal	Leadeth to self-immolation (180)
	Path of Woe (183)
Leads to the changeless change --Nirvana, the glorious state of absoluteness, the bliss past human thought	Leads to mental woe unspeakable; woe for the living dead, and helpless pity for the men of karmic sorrow; the fruit of Karma Sages dare not still (181,184)
	"Great Sifter" (120)
Embodiment of the external and nonexisting	Embodiment of Bodhi, the permanent and everlasting (127-8)
Inaction	Action (130)
	Yogi of Time's Circle [Kalacakra] (131)
	Bodhisattva of the Secret Heart (143)
Oblivion of the world and men for ever	Boundless pity and compassion for the world of deluded mortals (186-7)
Sweet fruits of rest and liberation for the sake of self	Sweeter fruits of long and bitter duty, renunciation for the sake of others (190)
Goal of bliss	Long Path of woe (194)
Pratyeka Buddha	Bodhisattva (191,306)
Sangna robe, Dharmakaya vesture	Nirmanakaya's humble robe (142,145,306)
Nirvani	Nirmanakaya--Buddha of Compassion (306)

Tape #5
VOICE OF THE SILENCE - Algeo
1/14/83

Chart 1

Dāna	Sthula Sharira	Yama
Shīla	Jiva	Niyama
Kshānti	Linga Sharira	Asana, Pranayama
Virāga	Kāma	Pratyahara
Vīrya	Manas	Dharana
Dhyāna	Buddhi	Dhyana
Prajña	Atma	Samadhi

Tape #5

VOICE OF THE SILENCE - Algeo

1/14/83
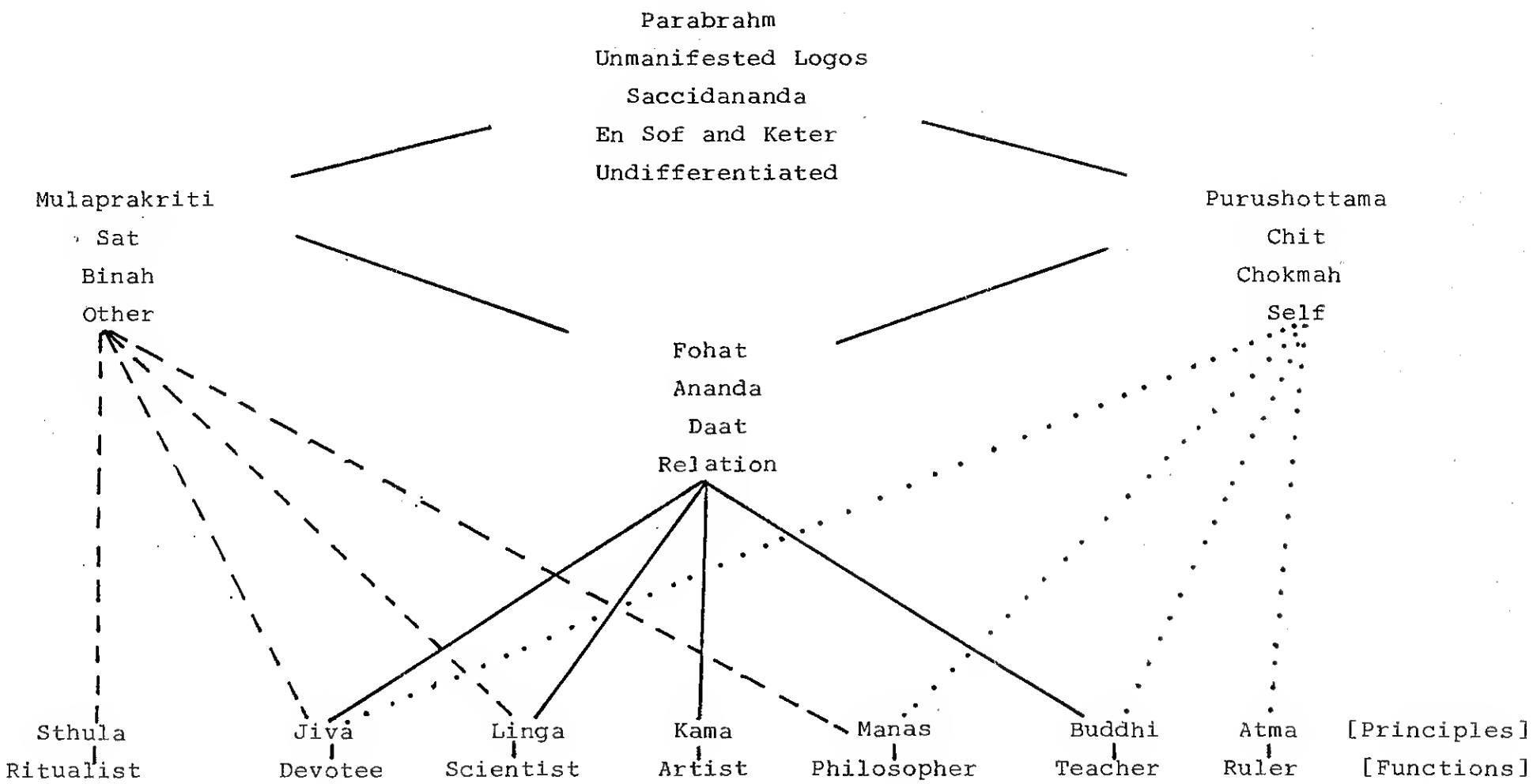
Chart 2